

The flight dream

Filght Gear is an open source simulation software that lets you fly a plane the way professionals do

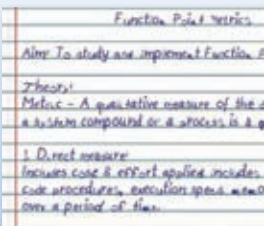
Community designed Cars

Toyota has joined hands with The Linux Foundation as a gold member to provide better dashboard computing and infotainment

Software from the Digit Community

This time around we feature two applications built by members of our community.
Keep sending us more of your software creations!

Automatic Assignment Writer



Writing by hand is so last century right? We think so too, and probably so does Digit Reader Pritesh Desai, who has come up with his own Assignment Writing Application. "Simply paste or write the answers and this baby will spit out pages with real handwriting in blue/black ink". He's having a bit of trouble making the prints look like real pen ink and is seeking the help of the Digit community. Any solutions? For more info: <http://bit.ly/aawriter>

Eagle Eye: Gesture Recognition Software



This neat little software designed by Digit reader Ashish Kapoor, is built in .NET. Using the software he has been able to control mouse movement and clicks, change volume, change PowerPoint slides, zooming in and out of images, and even playing simple flash games, etc. all via gestures. More info: <http://krunchd.com/eagleeye1>

A dark future

Captain Atul Bhatia, pilot and Digit reader wrote a modified version of our Future of Technology stories from the Anniversary issue.



For Monica Dutta this has been a demanding day, but nothing that she could not was away in a warm bubble bath. She flipped a switch as she entered the bathroom, thankful that she had insisted on having at least one point working off the old manual system - she'd been after the electrician for the past week to get the automated lighting fixed, but he seemed to be perpetually busy handling problems of 'more important' people in the society. As she stepped into the water she nearly shrieked - it was freezing cold! Must have been the load shedding extending into the later part of the evening. Sighing, she dipped her immersion rod and settled down to read the newspaper. Yikes; her tablet's battery



was low since she'd lapsed on her credit for recharging-on-the-move.

A few kilometers away, Agent 001 chafed in the front seat of his Smart Car. The traffic stretched away to infinity - he'd been stuck in a jam for the past two hours. Information streaming in over his reading screen had told him an hour ago that the traffic police's TRACON system had malfunctioned yet again - the fifth event in the past four days - and that there was no information on how long it would take to clear up. He'd heard on the grapevine that the police had not yet renewed their AMC for TRACON maintenance as a result of allegations of corruption in the e-tendering process and that the maintenance company had walked out after a month of maintaining the system gratis. Since then, his screen had dimmed and gone into power saving mode and the temperature inside the car had risen a few degrees - the nearby power tower had failed and power was being

supplied in reduced mode from a tower further away that was operating at peak load. He had tried getting out of the car but the onboard computer had deemed it unsafe and locked the doors.

In Navi Mumbai, Baiju anticipated the weekend ahead cheerily. He'd called his friends over for a movie. As he switched to pixel cloud mode he got nothing! A glance at the WiMax meter confirmed what he'd been dreading - there was no internet2 connection! Impatiently, he picked up his 3-D cellphone and dialled the company's helpline number, only to hear a voice say "all lines on this route are busy". As Baiju put the phone down, his doorbell rang; it was the first of many friends Baiju had to inform that instead of the QLED/Hologram movie they were intending to see, they would have to make do with what was running on the old LED lying in the corner.

Monica's dad on the other hand had dropped off the

electronic grid voluntarily a long time ago. His needs were few - cellphones and laptops had left his life; the house ran on a personal windmill he had installed. His bank account remained at minimum balance since he withdrew all his pension from the ATM on the first of each month.

Far fetched tale? Methinks, not. Concessions to futurisms aside, all of this has happened to me in some form or the other in the recent past. I find that technology has thrown in more problems than it has solved. Interestingly, the problem lies not with the technology itself - it is but a tool - rather, it lies in the way that we are wielding that tool. This is a human problem, and unless we humans see how best that technology can be exploited, rather than in terms of how much money that technology can 'make for me', I see a dark future ahead.